

University of the West Indies, Department of Computing
COMP3901 Group Project

Guidelines for assessing the midterm and final presentations

Midterm Presentations

Each group makes a presentation of what its project is about, what the objectives are, and what the current progress is.

The midterm presentation is worth 10% of the total grade.

- 5% for how clearly the project is defined
- 5% for the progress towards a solution

Objectives Clearly Defined:

[What is to be accomplished? Background or Context? What are Technical Issues?]

There should be a clear statement of what the project is about; the presentation normally describes the scope of the problem being worked on (what will definitely not be done, what will you definitely be done, and what might be done). There should be an attempt to minimize the uncertainty in what the project plans to accomplish. The presentation should address the challenges that are expected. This is where it should be brought out why the project is non-trivial. It is expected that the project would require knowledge from the courses in the curriculum to solve the problem.

Progress on Target and Well Organised:

[What needs to be done? Who is doing what? Do they know how it will be done?]

The presentation should provide a progress to date. It is not expected that there would be much to show, so examples of running code are not necessarily expected. However, it should be clear that the group has given the implementation enough thought to have been able to identify the areas that might pose a technical challenge.

Final Presentations

Each group makes a final presentation and demonstration of the project.

The final presentation is worth 15% of the total grade.

- 10% for the presentation quality
- 5% for the technology

The final demonstration is worth 15% of the total grade.

- 10% for the functionality
- 5% for the usability

Quality of Presentation:

Here we are looking for how well the presentation was made. The following factors (among others) should be taken into consideration:

- clarity of presentation (is it clear what the project was about)
- fit within time allotted?
- how smooth was the delivery?

Technology:

These marks are here to capture how well the project was designed to deal with some of the issues outside of the scope of the project, and the design of the actual implementation. The following factors should be taken into account:

- scalability: if the number of entities being dealt with were to increase dramatically, would their implementation stand up to it?
- robustness to specification change: how generalisable is the design?
- software engineering practises: are there reusable parts to the code? Is it well abstracted? Has it been reasonably documented?
- efficiency: does the implementation take into account any of the best algorithms for solving their problem? This is more important for projects whose main objective rests upon the use of a particular algorithm, or in which some task is performed repeatedly (and therefore needs to be fast).

Functionality:

Here we are assessing the demonstration of the capability of the project, relative to what was claimed in the presentation. We are trying to determine the extent to which the project has actually achieved that which it set out to do.

Usability:

This is not always distinct from functionality, but it is here to give credit to those who have put extra effort into making their project usable. We should be looking for the following:

- given the target audience, is the user interface appropriate?
- are there any unnecessary clicks or keypresses?
- is there functionality that is not accessible from the user interface, but should be?
- in cases where a user interface is "not necessary" (e.g. a filtering type of application) does the application support the provision of necessary switches, flags etc to allow the user to do what he ought to be able to with the application?

Level of Difficulty:

This is a (subjective) measure of how difficult you believe the overall project is to implement. Note that a project can be difficult because of its scope, or because of the background knowledge needed in order to complete it. The grade given here is used as a modifier on the presentation and functionality grades. A grade of 2 leaves the raw grades as they are, a grade of 1 gives more weight to the functionality, while a grade of 3 gives more weight to the presentation. (This is so that students who take on a difficult project and do not quite succeed, can make up for it by giving a good presentation). The following scale is a rough guide for the meaning of difficulty levels 1, 2 and 3.

- 1 = relatively easy, and somewhat below par for an undergraduate project. In other words, a group of bright high school students could do the same in the same amount of time.
- 2 = par: the level of difficulty is about right. Bright high school students would probably have a hard time finishing this on time, or not be able to do it at all.
- 3 = relatively difficult: The project would be difficult for undergraduates to complete, and nigh impossible for high school students to do.